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Title: Blood Culture Volume for Paediatric

Blood Culture Volume for Paediatric

Specimen Collection Instructions

- Specimen must be collected using sterile techniques to reduce the chance of contamination.
- The range of blood volume which can be cultured is 1.0 to 5.0 mL: (If the volume of blood cultured is less than 0.5 mL, recovery of some fastidious organisms, such as *Haemophilus* species, may require the use of an appropriate supplement)
- It is recommended that the specimen be inoculated into the **BD BACTEC** vials at bedside. Most commonly, a syringe with **BD Luer-Lok** brand tip is used to draw the sample.
- If using a needle and tubing set (direct draw), carefully observe the direction of blood flow when starting sample collection. The vacuum in the vial will usually exceed 5 mL, so the user should monitor the volume collected by means of the 5 mL graduation marks on the vial label.
- When the recommended 1-3 mL has been drawn, the flow should be stopped by crimping the tubing and removing the tubing set from the **BD BACTEC** vial. **The inoculated BD BACTEC vial should be transported as quickly as possible to the laboratory.**

Reference: BACTEC Peds Plus Culture Vials Instruction Guide

Checked by: DR. HANAN AL SAID

Authorized by: KHOULA JULENDA AL SAID

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